Mathieu Lindemann

Software Engineering Leader · Entrepreneur

I have 20 years of experience leading tech teams in startups and large companies.
My impact scales through the great individuals and organizations I develop.
I started, scaled and turned over distributed teams in the EU, APAC and the U.S.
I built and led critical organizations with 70+ engineers, systems serving billions of daily users and products with annual revenues over $200m.

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GOALS

I am passionate about engineering excellence, making it look simple thanks to meaningful individual and collective goals and nudges.

I deeply care about developing great engineers and managers, rooting quality, adaptability and transparency deep in the culture.

I lead by example, holding myself and the whole tech organization accountable, reliable, supportive and accessible to other functions.

I am industry-agnostic. I enjoyed working in real estate, payments, ad-tech, cloud and web search. People and culture trump tech- and industry-specific limitations.

SKILLS

TECH

- Backend
- ML, AI
- Lean/Agile
- Frontend
- SRE
- CI/CD

WORK EXPERIENCE

May 2023 – Jan 2021
Software Engineering Manager
Google Search · Zürich, Switzerland
Led a strategic effort of 20+ engineers in 5 time zones to identify authors of web pages, such as news articles and social posts, among the top 100bn web pages.
Built the long term vision with technical and non-technical stakeholders.
Set a culture of engineering excellence, improving e.g. data sourcing, prod monitoring.
Led key cross-functional efforts, e.g. impact on Search ranking, webmasters outreach.
Member of the **promotion committee** and **engineering velocity** steering committee.

Dec 2020 – May 2020
SRE Manager
Google Cloud AI · Zürich, Switzerland
Manager of the Zurich-based SRE team and mentor of the manager of the sister team in Pittsburgh, USA. These teams support Google Cloud AI products, 9-digit annual contract value and clients ranging from startups to Dow Jones-listed companies.
Got VP approval on **2 year plan** and **50% headcount growth** to support more services.
Reduced the alerts reaching the teams by 40% at no cost on client satisfaction.
Authored **2 guides on remote onboarding and people management**. Both became Google-wide official SRE material, reaching 3,000+ engineers.

Apr 2020 – Jan 2018
Co-founder, CTO & COO
Dili (Pinault Group) · Paris, France
Inspired by OpenDoor.com, Dili offered a hassle-free home selling experience in France.
Deployed the service to home sellers in France's 10 largest metropolitan areas.
Bootstrapped the tech and non-tech orgs (ops, marketing, sales, etc.), using the resources of Pinault real estate holding, **from 0 to positive EBITDA**.

Jan 2018 – Feb 2016
Engineering Program Manager
Criteo · Paris, France
Drove strategic-level R&D initiatives, leading 3 teams in machine learning (30+ FTE).
Reorganized the team in charge of core pricing models, **bringing +9% ARR (>180m€)** vs targeted +6% and **coaching a first-time manager** into a confident leader along the way.
Turned around an ML infra team, leading to fewer timeouts and **+1.6% ARR (>30m€)**.

Jan 2016 – Apr 2014
CTO & General Manager for Vietnam
helloPay | Rocket Internet · Ho Chi Minh City, Vietnam
helloPay was Rocket Internet's e-payment startup for Asia and a spinoff of Lazada.
Bootstrapped the tech org and systems from 0 to our acquisition by Alibaba/Alipay.
Grew the tech offices **from scratch to 70+ engineers** in Singapore and Ho Chi Minh City.
Represented helloPay technical interests in regulator audits and PCI DSS 1 application.

Apr 2014 – Apr 2012
Head of Software Development
Bouygues · Ho Chi Minh City, Vietnam
Designed and led a 2-year performance improvement plan to regain trust from HQ.
Dropped non-strategic activities to **focus** on high-value projects.
Simplified the processes, replacing meaningless routines with lean practices.
Implemented **career management** to develop leaders and high potential employees.
Results: rework decreased by 40%. The office still exists as of May 2023.

Work experience from 2004 to 2012 is visible on **LinkedIn**.

STRENGTHS

Reliable · Autonomous · Transparent · Accountable · Team player · Focused
Pragmatic · Adaptable · Customer-centric · Cross-functional · Open to criticism

LANGUAGES

English	Fluent
French	Mother tongue
Italian	Working proficiency
Spanish	Notions (eager to practice)
Vietnamese	Notions (eager to practice)

PHILOSOPHY

Here are some thoughts that guide my actions as a manager and as a colleague.

> *Success is a few simple disciplines, practiced every day; while failure is simply a few errors in judgment, repeated every day.*
> –Jim Rohn

> *With most subjects, it is more important to really understand the basic material than have exposure to more advanced concepts.*
> –S. S. Skiena

> *Besides the noble art of getting things done, there is the noble art of leaving things undone. The wisdom of life consists in the elimination of non-essentials.*
> –Lin Yutang

> *The people that really create the things that change this industry are both the thinker and doer in one person. [...] It's very easy to say "I thought of this three years ago". But usually when you dig a little deeper, you find that the people that really did it were also the people that really worked through the hard intellectual problems as well.*
> –Steve Jobs

FORMAL EDUCATION

Jul 2004
Sep 2001

Ingénieur des Mines
M.Sc. · École des Mines de Paris · Paris, France
Mines ParisTech is one of the world's best universities, **ranked 31st globally** by the NY Times. **Major: Engineering Design & Management**, i.e. how to lead engineering teams to game-changing innovation.

SELF-EDUCATION

Oct 2017

Neural Networks and Deep Learning
DeepLearning.ai via Coursera
This class covered the key DL methods used in 2017, such as CNN or LSTM. It required to implement them from scratch using **GNU Octave** to understand their strengths and limitations in detail.
Results: **Statement of Accomplishment**.

Dec 2013

Introduction to Operations Management
Wharton via Coursera
This online class covered practical concepts of operations management such as takt time or debottlenecking, and powerful frameworks like the Toyota Production System.
Results: **Statement of Accomplishment with distinction**.
I was also invited to TA the following iterations of the course and, ultimately, to proofread the draft of the next edition of Pr. Terwiesch's book ***"Matching Supply with Demand, an introduction to Operations Management"*** (ISBN: 978-1260084610).

Oct 2013

CS191x: Quantum Mechanics and Quantum Computation
Berkeley via edX
This online class was taught by Pr. Umesh Vazirani. It covered theoretical concepts of quantum physics (e.g. superposition of states, entanglement of particles) as well as practical implementations of quantum algorithms such as Shor's algorithm to factor large numbers.
Results: **Statement of Accomplishment**.

PATENTS

Oct 2017

Predictive adjusted bidding for electronic advertisements
Criteo · Paris, France
I participated in the design of patent **#US11120481B2** while leading a long-shot project to detect auction mechanisms, from pure first-price to pure second-price with many variations in between. The stake was to optimize Criteo bidding strategy accordingly and secure the company's margin.

MENTORING

Since 2016	One ex-report engineering manager from Criteo who now works at Google.
Since 2018	One ex-report data engineer from Dili who became manager at H&M.
Since 2022	One backend engineer at Android, as part of Google mentoring program.

REFERENCES

My references are available upon request. Among others, they include:

Managers	A former CTO at Criteo and senior director at Google.
Reports	The VP of engineering at the fastest growing startup in the Middle East, whom I mentored at helloPay.